

Product Requirements Document: Grants Intake Process

1. Document Control

Field Value

Product Dual-Sided Grants Lifecycle Management Platform

Module Grants Intake

Document Type Product Requirements Document, PRD

Version 1.0 Draft

Prepared For Product, UX, Architecture, Engineering, Compliance, and Delivery Teams

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Scope Boundary Opportunity setup through validated application intake and handoff to review

2. Purpose

This PRD defines the product requirements for the Grants Intake process within an end-to-end Grants Lifecycle Management platform. The intake module enables grantors to configure and publish funding opportunities, applicants to determine eligibility and prepare submissions, and both parties to manage shared intake transactions in a structured, auditable, and low-burden workflow.

The module is designed for U.S. grant markets, including federal, state/local, philanthropic, corporate, and pass-through grant programs. The intake module must support grantor-private configuration work, grantee-private preparation work, and shared grantor-grantee submission workflows.

3. Scope

3.1 In Scope

The Grants Intake module covers:

Program and opportunity intake setup by grantor

Opportunity publication and applicant-facing discovery

Applicant organization profile and credential readiness

Eligibility pre-screening

Pre-application, letter of intent, and full application intake

Collaborative application workspace

Form, narrative, budget, and attachment collection

Q&A / clarifications / addenda

Application validation and completeness checks

Authorized submission and certification

Submission receipt, timestamping, and tracking

Intake queue and initial administrative screening

Handoff to review, scoring, and risk assessment

Intake analytics and pipeline dashboards

3.2 Out of Scope

The following are out of scope for this intake PRD:

Full merit review and scoring execution

Award creation and acceptance

Post-award reporting

Reimbursement and payment requests

Subrecipient monitoring after award

Closeout and retention beyond intake submission records

Full ERP accounting integration

Automated award decisioning

Autonomous AI-generated application submission

3.3 Intake Boundary Definition

The intake process begins when a grantor creates or imports a funding opportunity and ends when a validated application is accepted into the intake queue and made available for review, scoring, eligibility disposition, or applicant risk assessment.

4. Evidence and Regulatory Context

Federal grants require structured funding opportunity notices, including agency name, opportunity title, announcement type, funding opportunity number, Assistance Listing number, funding details, key dates, executive summary, and agency contact information. Federal agencies are also encouraged to use plain language, reduce announcement complexity, and consider whether requirements must be met at application time or can be deferred to award stage. 2 CFR 200.204

Grants.gov requires applicant organizations to register with SAM.gov, obtain a Unique Entity ID, renew SAM registration annually, and use organization roles such as EBiz POC, AOR, Workspace Manager, and custom roles for application access and submission. Grants.gov Applicant Registration, Grants.gov Workspace Roles

Federal agencies must conduct merit review for competitive awards and must review applicant risk before issuing awards. Therefore, intake must capture enough structured information, submission metadata, and administrative screening results to support downstream review and risk assessment. 2 CFR 200.205, 2 CFR 200.206

The Simpler.Grants.gov modernization initiative emphasizes improving the grant search and application experience, reducing applicant burden, and moving toward simpler, more accessible grant interactions. Simpler.Grants.gov Vision, Simpler.Grants.gov Roadmap

Candid's Demographics via Candid initiative reflects a broader sector need to reduce repeated data collection by allowing nonprofits to maintain reusable demographic/profile information that funders can request consistently. Candid Demographics via Candid

5. Product Vision

Create a low-burden, rules-driven, auditable grants intake experience that allows grantors to publish well-structured opportunities, allows applicants to reuse profile data and submit complete applications, and gives grant administrators a clean, validated, review-ready intake queue.

The intake module should reduce friction at three levels:

Grantor burden: reduce manual setup, repetitive form building, unclear eligibility logic, and incomplete submissions.

Applicant burden: reduce duplicate profile entry, unclear requirements, last-minute validation failures, and role confusion.

Shared transaction burden: create a single authoritative application record with clear status, audit history, receipts, and downstream handoff.

6. Product Goals

Goal ID	Goal	Description	Success Metric
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G-001	Improve opportunity setup quality	Grantors can create structured, plain-language, complete opportunities using reusable templates.	90% of published opportunities pass required metadata validation on first publish attempt.
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G-002 Reduce applicant data re-entry Applicants reuse organization profile, contacts, credentials, and standard attachments across applications. 60% of organization profile fields reused across repeat applications within 12 months.

G-003 Increase submission completeness Applications are validated continuously before final submission. 40% reduction in returned/incomplete applications after launch.

G-004 Reduce deadline failure risk Applicants and grantors receive clear due dates, checklist status, and role-based alerts. 95% of started applications display complete deadline and checklist information.

G-005 Improve intake handoff quality Grant reviewers receive structured, review-ready application packages. 90% of submitted applications enter review queue with required administrative fields populated.

G-006 Preserve auditability Every shared intake transaction is timestamped, versioned, and attributable. 100% of final submissions generate immutable submission snapshots and receipts.

7. Personas

7.1 Grantor Personas

Persona Responsibilities	Intake Pain Points	Product Need
Program Officer Defines program goals, eligibility, review criteria, and funding priorities.	Opportunity setup is often document-heavy and inconsistent.	
Guided opportunity builder with templates, required fields, and plain-language prompts.		
Grant Intake Administrator	Manages application intake, applicant questions, deadlines, and administrative screening.	Incomplete applications and email-based clarifications create rework.
Compliance / Policy Analyst	Ensures opportunity and intake process comply with program and policy rules.	Intake queue, validation dashboard, Q&A manager, and administrative screening checklist.
	Requirements may be buried in attachments and not enforceable by system logic.	
	Configurable business rules, eligibility logic, and evidence requirements.	
Grantor System Administrator	Configures forms, workflows, roles, and integration settings.	No-code / low-code configuration model with controlled defaults.
Intake Reviewer / Triage User	Conducts initial screening before full review.	
Reviewers receive inconsistent packets and missing metadata.		Standardized submission package and triage disposition workflow.

7.2 Grantee / Applicant Personas

Persona Responsibilities	Intake Pain Points	Product Need
Organization Administrator	Maintains organization profile, UEI/SAM data, contacts, roles, and standard documents.	Profile and credentials are repeatedly entered across portals.
		Reusable organization profile, credential vault, and document library.
Proposal Lead	Coordinates application preparation and internal deadlines.	
Collaboration happens in email, shared drives, and disconnected forms.		Application workspace with tasking, section ownership, comments, and readiness dashboard.
Authorized Representative	Certifies and submits final application.	
Submit authority is unclear or available too late.		Explicit submit permissions, certification workflow, and final package preview.
Finance Contributor	Provides budget, match, indirect cost, and financial	

attachments. Budget data is separated from narrative and eligibility logic. Structured budget forms, validations, and attachment requirements. External Partner / Subapplicant Contributes letters, documents, workplan inputs, or partner budgets. External collaboration risks overexposure of applicant-private data. Limited-access contributor role and scoped document requests.

8. Intake Workflow Model

8.1 Workflow Zones

Zone	Description	Examples
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Grantor-private	Work visible only to grantor users before publication or before a shared decision.	Program setup, opportunity drafts, internal intake rules, reviewer handoff rules.
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Grantee-private	Work visible only to applicant organization before submission.	Draft application, internal comments, reusable profile, draft budget, partner coordination.
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Shared transaction	Work visible to both parties according to status and permissions.	Published opportunity, submitted application, Q&A, addenda, receipt, revision request.
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8.2 High-Level Intake Flow

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flowchart LR

A[Grantor creates program/opportunity] --> B[Configure eligibility, forms, budget, attachments]

B --> C[Publish opportunity]

C --> D[Applicant discovers opportunity]

D --> E[Applicant confirms profile and eligibility]

E --> F[Application workspace created]

F --> G[Collaborative drafting and document collection]

G --> H[System validation and internal approval]

H --> I[Authorized submission]

I --> J[Submission receipt and immutable snapshot]

J --> K[Intake queue and administrative screening]

K --> L[Handoff to review/risk assessment]

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9. Intake Stages and Product Requirements

Stage 1: Program and Opportunity Setup

Objective: Enable grantors to create structured, accessible, and configurable grant opportunities.

PRD ID	Requirement	Priority
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PRD-INTAKE-001	The product shall allow grantor users to create a new funding opportunity from configurable templates.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-002	The product shall capture structured opportunity metadata, including opportunity title, funding source, announcement type, opportunity number, funding amount/range, expected number of awards, key dates, eligibility summary, contact information, and executive summary.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-003	The product shall support plain-language guidance prompts for opportunity descriptions and applicant instructions.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-004	The product shall allow grantors to configure opportunity types	
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such as competitive, formula, rolling intake, invitation-only, continuation, renewal, and pass-through subaward. Phase 2

PRD-INTAKE-005 The product shall allow grantors to configure intake windows, deadlines, pre-application deadlines, letter-of-intent deadlines, and rolling review periods. MVP

PRD-INTAKE-006 The product shall validate opportunity setup completeness before publication. MVP

PRD-INTAKE-007 The product shall version every published opportunity and maintain an audit trail of modifications and addenda. MVP

Stage 2: Eligibility and Intake Rules Configuration

Objective: Allow grantors to convert eligibility and submission requirements into enforceable system rules.

PRD ID	Requirement	Priority
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PRD-INTAKE-008	The product shall allow grantors to define eligibility rules by applicant type, geography, entity status, UEI/SAM requirement, nonprofit status, tribal status, state/local status, prior award status, match requirement, and program-specific criteria.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-009	The product shall distinguish hard eligibility blockers from advisory fit indicators.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-010	The product shall support configurable pre-screening questionnaires.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-011	The product shall support conditional forms and sections based on applicant type, program, geography, funding request amount, or eligibility response.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-012	The product shall allow grantors to define required attachments and evidence by opportunity, applicant type, and application stage.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-013	The product shall allow grantors to configure administrative screening criteria used after submission.	MVP
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Stage 3: Opportunity Publication and Discovery

Objective: Provide applicants with a clear, searchable, accessible view of available opportunities.

PRD ID	Requirement	Priority
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PRD-INTAKE-014	The product shall publish approved opportunities to an applicant-facing portal.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-015	The product shall provide search and filtering by funder, program area, geography, eligibility type, funding amount, due date, application stage, and keyword.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-016	The product shall allow applicants to save opportunities, subscribe to notifications, and compare eligibility requirements.	Phase 2
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PRD-INTAKE-017	The product shall support public opportunity pages and authenticated applicant workspaces.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-018	The product shall display opportunity changes, addenda, Q&A updates, and deadline changes to applicants.	MVP
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Stage 4: Organization Profile and Credential Readiness

Objective: Reduce repeated application burden by maintaining reusable applicant data.

PRD ID	Requirement	Priority
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PRD-INTAKE-019	The product shall allow applicants to create and maintain reusable organization profiles.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-020	The organization profile shall capture legal name, DBA, address,	
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entity type, UEI, SAM status where applicable, tax status, contacts, authorized representatives, banking readiness indicator, and standard documents. MVP

PRD-INTAKE-021 The product shall store reusable standard attachments such as IRS determination letter, W-9, audit reports, indirect cost agreement, board roster, insurance certificate, and letters of support. MVP

PRD-INTAKE-022 The product shall warn applicants when credentials, documents, or registrations are expired or approaching expiration. MVP

PRD-INTAKE-023 The product shall support role assignment for organization admin, proposal lead, contributor, finance contributor, and authorized representative. MVP

PRD-INTAKE-024 The product shall allow applicants to reuse profile fields across applications while preserving opportunity-specific snapshots at submission. MVP

Stage 5: Eligibility Pre-Screening

Objective: Help applicants determine whether to proceed and help grantors reduce unqualified submissions.

PRD ID	Requirement	Priority
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PRD-INTAKE-025	The product shall provide an eligibility pre-screen workflow before application workspace creation or before full submission, depending on opportunity configuration.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-026	The product shall show applicants eligibility results as eligible, likely eligible, needs attention, or ineligible, based on configured rules.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-027	The product shall explain which eligibility responses caused a blocker or warning.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-028	The product shall allow grantors to decide whether ineligible applicants may still submit with an exception explanation.	Phase 2
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PRD-INTAKE-029	The product shall store eligibility responses as part of the intake record and carry them into administrative screening.	MVP
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Stage 6: Application Workspace

Objective: Provide a collaborative, structured, and controlled application preparation environment.

PRD ID	Requirement	Priority
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PRD-INTAKE-030	The product shall create one application workspace per applicant organization per opportunity, unless duplicate applications are allowed by configuration.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-031	The workspace shall include sections for organization profile, eligibility, narrative, budget, workplan, performance measures, attachments, certifications, and review/submit.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-032	The product shall allow section ownership, due dates, internal tasks, comments, and contributor assignments.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-033	The product shall support private internal applicant comments that are not visible to grantors.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-034	The product shall support applicant-side internal review and approval before final submission.	Phase 2
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PRD-INTAKE-035	The product shall provide a readiness dashboard showing completion status, blocking errors, warnings, required attachments, and submit-role readiness.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-036	The product shall support saving drafts without exposing content to the grantor until submission, except for configured pre-application or Q&A workflows.	MVP
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Stage 7: Form, Budget, and Attachment Intake

Objective: Capture intake data as structured data wherever possible, not only as

uploaded PDFs.

PRD ID	Requirement	Priority
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PRD-INTAKE-037	The product shall support configurable forms with text, number, date, currency, picklist, checkbox, file upload, calculated fields, and repeating tables.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-038	The product shall support page/character limits, required fields, conditional fields, and formatting guidance.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-039	The product shall support structured budget capture with configurable categories, cost-share/match, indirect cost, budget periods, and budget justification.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-040	The product shall validate budget totals, match requirements, funding request ceilings, and required budget justifications.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-041	The product shall support attachment requirements by application section and applicant type.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-042	The product shall support document versioning and replacement history for uploaded attachments.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-043	The product shall generate a submission package preview before final submission.	MVP
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Stage 8: Q&A, Clarifications, and Addenda

Objective: Manage applicant questions and opportunity clarifications in a transparent, auditable way.

PRD ID	Requirement	Priority
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PRD-INTAKE-044	The product shall allow grantors to configure whether applicants can submit questions during an opportunity period.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-045	The product shall allow grantors to publish public Q&A responses visible to all applicants.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-046	The product shall allow private applicant-specific clarification only when configured and permitted by funder policy.	Phase 2
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PRD-INTAKE-047	The product shall maintain an auditable history of questions, responses, addenda, and date changes.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-048	The product shall notify applicants of published addenda, changed dates, or required application changes.	MVP
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Stage 9: Validation and Submission

Objective: Ensure only authorized, complete, and review-ready submissions enter the grantor intake queue.

PRD ID	Requirement	Priority
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PRD-INTAKE-049	The product shall support continuous validation during drafting and final validation at submission.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-050	The product shall classify validation messages as informational, warning, or blocking.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-051	The product shall block submission when mandatory fields, certifications, signatures, attachments, eligibility responses, budget requirements, or authorized submitter requirements are missing.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-052	The product shall require final certification by an authorized representative before submission.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-053	The product shall generate a final immutable submission snapshot, timestamp, confirmation number, and receipt.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-054	The product shall preserve both human-readable application package and machine-readable structured data package.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-055	The product shall prevent post-submission edits unless the	
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application is withdrawn, reopened, or returned for correction according to configured workflow. MVP

Stage 10: Intake Queue and Administrative Screening

Objective: Give grantors a structured queue for receiving, validating, triaging, and routing applications.

PRD ID	Requirement	Priority
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PRD-INTAKE-056	The product shall route submitted applications into an intake queue by opportunity, applicant type, region, funding track, or configured workflow.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-057	The product shall display submission status, timestamp, applicant profile, eligibility results, validation summary, attachments, and requested amount.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-058	The product shall support administrative screening dispositions such as accepted for review, returned for correction, withdrawn, ineligible, duplicate, late, or administratively rejected.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-059	The product shall allow grantors to request correction or clarification when allowed by opportunity rules.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-060	The product shall preserve original submission snapshots when corrections or resubmissions are requested.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-061	The product shall route accepted applications to review, scoring, or applicant risk assessment workflows.	MVP
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Stage 11: Intake Analytics and Reporting

Objective: Provide grantors and applicants visibility into intake status, bottlenecks, and quality.

PRD ID	Requirement	Priority
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PRD-INTAKE-062	The product shall provide grantor dashboards for opportunity views, started applications, submitted applications, incomplete applications, validation errors, late submissions, and intake disposition.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-063	The product shall provide applicant dashboards for saved opportunities, application progress, upcoming deadlines, missing items, and submission history.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-064	The product shall allow export of intake data for reporting and audit purposes.	MVP
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PRD-INTAKE-065	The product shall provide analytics on common validation failures and applicant burden indicators.	Phase 2
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PRD-INTAKE-066	The product shall support portfolio-level intake analytics across funders, programs, or cycles.	Phase 2
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10. MVP Scope

10.1 MVP Capabilities

The MVP must include:

- Opportunity builder

- Eligibility rule configuration

- Applicant-facing opportunity portal

- Organization profile and credential management

- Application workspace

- Form, budget, and attachment intake

- Q&A and addenda publishing

- Validation engine

- Authorized submission workflow

- Submission receipt and immutable snapshot

Intake queue

Administrative screening and handoff to review

Role-based access control

Basic notifications and reminders

Basic intake dashboards

10.2 MVP Non-Goals

The MVP will not include:

Automated award decisioning

Full post-award management

AI-generated proposal content as a core feature

Direct payment processing

Full Grants.gov System-to-System integration at launch

Advanced portfolio optimization

Complex multi-stage subrecipient monitoring

Full cross-funder universal applicant profile network

11. Product Principles

Principle	Description
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Intake should be structured, not document-only. Capture data in forms, fields, tables, and objects wherever possible.	
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Applicants should enter data once and reuse it. Organization profiles, documents, credentials, and contacts should persist across opportunities.	
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Validation should happen early. Applicants should not discover fatal errors only at final submission.	
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Private work must stay private. Draft application content and applicant comments should remain grantee-private until submission.	
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Shared transactions must be immutable. Final submissions, receipts, and official communications must be preserved.	
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Grantors need configuration with guardrails. Program-specific flexibility is required, but the product should provide strong defaults.	
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Accessibility and plain language matter. Intake should support applicants with varying levels of grant-writing maturity.	
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AI should assist, not decide. AI may summarize, extract, or suggest, but final certifications and submissions require human action.	
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12. Key Data Objects

Object	Description	Ownership
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Program	Funder-defined program or funding stream.	Grantor
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Opportunity	Published or draft funding opportunity.	Grantor / Shared after publication
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Eligibility Rule	Configured rules for applicant fit and blockers.	Grantor
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Application Workspace	Applicant-private drafting environment.	Grantee
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Organization Profile	Reusable applicant entity record.	Grantee
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Contact / User Role	User identity and application permissions.	Tenant / Organization
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Application Section	Narrative, budget, attachment, certification, or form section.	Grantee before submit / Shared after submit
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Budget	Structured request and match/cost share details.	Grantee before submit / Shared after submit
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Attachment	Uploaded evidence, documents, letters, or forms.	Depends on context
Question / Answer	Applicant question and grantor response.	Shared or grantor-private until published
Addendum	Published opportunity change.	Grantor / Shared after publication
Submission Snapshot	Immutable final submitted application package.	Shared
Intake Disposition	Administrative screening outcome.	Grantor / Shared when configured
Audit Event	System-generated event record.	System

13. Roles and Permissions

Role	Create Opportunity	Manage Q&A	Configure Rules	Screen Intake	Draft Application	View Submission	Submit	
Grantor Admin	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	
Program Officer	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	
Intake Administrator	Limited	Limited	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes
Compliance Analyst	Review	Review	No	No	No	Review	Yes	Yes
Applicant Org Admin only	No	No	No	Yes	Depends	No	No	Own org
Proposal Lead only	No	No	Yes	Depends	Ask questions	No	No	Own app
Finance Contributor app budget only	No	No	No	Budget only	No	No	No	Own
External Contributor Scoped only	No	No	No	Scoped sections	No	No	No	
Authorized Representative Own app only			No	No	Review	Yes	Ask questions	No
Reviewer handoff only	No	No	No	No	No	No	After intake	

14. User Experience Requirements

14.1 Grantor Experience

The grantor experience must provide:

Guided opportunity setup wizard

Opportunity template library

Required metadata checklist

Eligibility rule builder

Form and attachment builder

Deadline and timeline manager

Q&A / addendum manager

Intake queue dashboard

Administrative screening panel

Exportable intake package

14.2 Applicant Experience

The applicant experience must provide:

Searchable opportunity portal

Saved opportunities

Eligibility pre-check

Organization profile manager

Application workspace

Section checklist

Budget builder

Attachment manager

Validation panel

Submission preview

Final certification and receipt

Status tracking

14.3 Shared Experience

The shared experience must provide:

Published opportunity page

Public Q&A and addenda

Application status tracker

Official messages

Revision or correction requests

Submission receipt

Intake disposition visibility where configured

15. Notifications

Notification	Recipient	Trigger	Priority	
Opportunity published to published	MVP	Subscribers / applicants		Opportunity status changes
Opportunity modified date change	MVP	Applicants with saved or started application		Addendum or
Question answered	Applicants	Public answer posted	MVP	
Workspace created	Applicant team	Application workspace creation	MVP	
Deadline approaching	Applicant team	Configured days before due date	MVP	
Missing required item	Proposal lead	Blocking validation detected	MVP	
Ready for submission	Authorized representative	Internal checklist complete		
MVP				
Submission received	Applicant team and grantor intake admin	Final submit	MVP	
Returned for correction	Applicant team	Grantor disposition	MVP	
Intake accepted for review	Applicant team and reviewers	Screening complete		
MVP				

16. Intake Status Model

16.1 Opportunity Status

Draft → Internal Review → Approved → Published → Modified → Closed → Archived

16.2 Application Status

Not Started → Workspace Created → In Progress → Ready for Internal Review → Ready to Submit → Submitted → Intake Screening → Returned for Correction → Resubmitted → Accepted for Review → Withdrawn → Administratively Rejected

16.3 Question / Addendum Status

Draft → Internal Review → Published → Superseded / Archived

16.4 Intake Disposition Status

Pending Screening → Accepted for Review → Returned for Correction → Ineligible → Late → Duplicate → Withdrawn → Administratively Rejected

17. Functional Epics

Epic ID	Epic Description	MVP / Later
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EPIC-INTAKE-001	Opportunity Builder	Configure and publish opportunities with
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metadata, rules, forms, attachments, and deadlines. MVP

EPIC-INTAKE-002 Eligibility Engine Pre-screen applicants and enforce eligibility blockers/warnings. MVP

EPIC-INTAKE-003 Organization Profile Reuse Maintain reusable applicant profile, credentials, contacts, and standard documents. MVP

EPIC-INTAKE-004 Application Workspace Enable collaborative application preparation with tasks, sections, comments, and checklist. MVP

EPIC-INTAKE-005 Structured Data Intake Capture narrative, budget, performance, and attachment data using configurable forms. MVP

EPIC-INTAKE-006 Validation and Submission Provide continuous validation, final certification, immutable submission, and receipt. MVP

EPIC-INTAKE-007 Q&A and Addenda Manage applicant questions and public clarifications. MVP

EPIC-INTAKE-008 Intake Queue and Screening Route submitted applications to grantor administrative screening and review handoff. MVP

EPIC-INTAKE-009 Intake Analytics Provide dashboards and burden/error analytics. Phase 2

EPIC-INTAKE-010 Assistive AI for Intake Summarize opportunity requirements, extract attachments, suggest missing data, and assist plain-language review. Phase 2

18. Acceptance Criteria

18.1 Opportunity Setup

Grantor can create a funding opportunity from template.
 Required metadata must be complete before publication.
 Opportunity can be previewed as applicant-facing page before publishing.
 Published opportunity creates a public or restricted applicant-facing page.
 Modifications create version history and notification triggers.

18.2 Applicant Profile

Applicant can create organization profile.
 Applicant can store UEI/SAM details where applicable.
 Applicant can upload reusable documents.
 Applicant can assign team roles.
 Profile fields can be reused into application forms.

18.3 Eligibility

Applicant can complete pre-screening questionnaire.
 System displays blockers and warnings.
 Ineligible result prevents workspace creation or submission when configured.
 Eligibility responses are saved into application record.

18.4 Application Workspace

Proposal lead can assign section owners.
 Contributors can only access scoped sections.
 Internal comments remain private.
 Checklist shows missing required items.
 Application draft remains grantee-private until submission.

18.5 Submission

Only authorized submitter can submit.
 Blocking validations prevent submission.
 Submission creates immutable snapshot, receipt number, timestamp, and audit record.
 Applicant can download submission package.
 Grantor can see submitted package in intake queue.

18.6 Intake Screening

Intake admin can view all submitted applications by opportunity.

Intake admin can apply administrative screening disposition.

Returned-for-correction workflows preserve original submission.

Accepted applications route to review workflow.

19. Success Metrics

Metric	Definition	Target
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Setup completeness rate	Published opportunities that pass all metadata checks on first attempt	90%
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Applicant profile reuse rate	Percentage of application fields populated from reusable profile	60%
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Validation error reduction	Reduction in final-submit blocking errors after continuous validation	40%
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Incomplete submission rate	Applications returned for missing required data or attachment	<10%
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Intake cycle time	Median time from submit to administrative disposition	Reduce by 30%
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Applicant satisfaction	Applicant rating of intake clarity and ease	4.2 / 5 or better
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Grantor satisfaction	Grantor rating of intake queue usability	4.2 / 5 or better
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Audit completeness	Submissions with full snapshot, receipt, and audit trail	100%
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20. Risks and Mitigations

Risk ID	Risk	Impact	Mitigation
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R-001	Over-configurable forms become hard to manage.	Grantors create inconsistent, unusable applications.	Provide templates, guardrails, and required metadata validation.
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R-002	Applicants still need external systems such as SAM.gov or Grants.gov.	Users may expect this product to replace all federal portals.	Clearly position as intake orchestration; add integrations in phases.
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R-003	Eligibility logic may be too complex for simple rules.	False blockers could prevent valid submissions.	Separate hard blockers from advisory warnings and support exception flows.
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R-004	Draft privacy boundaries may be misunderstood.	Applicant trust and compliance risk.	Explicit private/shared labels and submission preview.
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R-005	Grantors may want post-award functions inside intake MVP.	Scope creep.	Keep intake handoff boundary explicit.
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R-006	AI-generated guidance may be treated as official determination.	Legal/compliance risk.	Label AI as assistive only and require source-linked, human-approved guidance.
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21. Roadmap

MVP: Intake Foundation

Opportunity builder

Eligibility builder

Applicant portal

Organization profile

Application workspace
Structured form/budget/attachment intake
Validation and submission
Intake queue
Administrative screening
Submission receipt and audit log
Phase 2: Advanced Intake Operations
Opportunity comparison
Advanced eligibility logic
Internal applicant approval workflow
Public and private Q&A modes
Correction / resubmission branch logic
Intake analytics and burden metrics
Integration with SAM APIs and external opportunity feeds
Assistive AI for summarization, extraction, and validation suggestions
Phase 3: Network and Interoperability
Cross-funder organization profile reuse
Grants.gov System-to-System connector
Common data standard exports
Advanced API marketplace for funders and partners
Universal application package interoperability
Multi-grantor intake network model

22. Open Questions

QO ID	Question	Why It Matters
QO-001	Should MVP support only grantor-hosted opportunities or also external opportunity ingestion?	Determines discovery and integration scope.
QO-002	Should SAM.gov validation be manual entry, assisted lookup, or API-integrated in MVP?	Determines engineering complexity and federal readiness.
QO-003	Should applicants be allowed to submit if eligibility pre-screen fails?	Affects fairness, exception handling, and funder policy.
QO-004	Should internal applicant approval be MVP or Phase 2?	Affects workflow and role model complexity.
QO-005	Should public Q&A be anonymous, named, or funder-configurable?	Affects fairness, privacy, and transparency.
QO-006	What level of budget complexity is needed in MVP?	Affects data model and usability.
QO-007	Should reviewers access applications directly from intake or via separate review module only?	Affects handoff model and permissions.
QO-008	Should this product support philanthropic common applications differently from federal-style NOFOs?	Affects templates and terminology.
QO-009	Should duplicate applications be blocked, warned, or allowed?	Affects multi-program and multi-track use cases.
QO-010	What is the minimum evidence package required for audit-ready intake?	Affects document retention and event logging.

23. Source Appendix

2 CFR 200.204, Notices of Funding Opportunities
2 CFR 200.205, Federal Agency Review of Merit of Proposals
2 CFR 200.206, Federal Agency Review of Risk Posed by Applicants

Grants.gov Applicant Registration
Grants.gov Workspace Roles
Simpler.Grants.gov Vision
Simpler.Grants.gov Roadmap
Candid: Demographics via Candid

24. Traceability Summary

Pain Point	Product Response	Related Requirements
Applicants repeatedly enter the same organization data.	Reusable organization profile and document library.	PRD-INTAKE-019 to PRD-INTAKE-024
Applicants discover fatal submission errors too late.	Continuous validation and readiness dashboard.	PRD-INTAKE-035, PRD-INTAKE-049 to PRD-INTAKE-055
Grantors receive incomplete or inconsistent applications.	Required metadata, form builder, attachment rules, and intake screening.	PRD-INTAKE-001 to PRD-INTAKE-013, PRD-INTAKE-056 to PRD-INTAKE-061
Eligibility rules are unclear or buried in documents.	Configurable eligibility engine with blockers and warnings.	PRD-INTAKE-008 to PRD-INTAKE-013, PRD-INTAKE-025 to PRD-INTAKE-029
Application collaboration happens in email and shared drives.	Application workspace with roles, tasks, comments, and section ownership.	PRD-INTAKE-030 to PRD-INTAKE-036
Official submissions lack a clean, auditable record.	Immutable submission snapshot, timestamp, confirmation number, and audit event.	PRD-INTAKE-052 to PRD-INTAKE-055
Grantors struggle to manage applicant questions and addenda.	Q&A and addenda workflow with notifications.	PRD-INTAKE-044 to PRD-INTAKE-048
Intake handoff to review is messy.	Administrative screening and routing to review/risk workflows.	PRD-INTAKE-056 to PRD-INTAKE-061